

Masturbation

Masturbation is often a person's first sexual experience. It's a common form of sexual activity that involves touching the genitals. It carries no risk of pregnancy or sexually transmitted diseases (STDs). It's up to a teen whether they want to masturbate or not—some people like it and others don't.

What is masturbation?

Masturbation is touching or rubbing of the genitals and other parts of the body for sexual pleasure. It often, but not always, ends in orgasm. An orgasm is the climax of sexual arousal. It feels pleasurable and usually includes a release of fluid from the penis and sometimes from the vagina (known as ejaculation).

People start masturbating at different ages, and some never start at all. It all comes down to personal preference—it appeals to some people, but not to others. It's a way for people to learn about their bodies and discover what they like.

▷ Curious feelings

Many teens masturbate for the first time because they are curious about sex and how it feels.

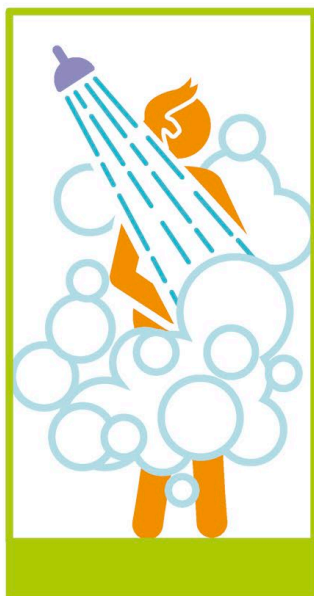


A normal activity

Masturbation is a natural part of human sexuality. It can be done alone or with a partner. No one should feel pressured to masturbate if it doesn't appeal to them.

As a part of foreplay or sex, some people in relationships engage in "mutual masturbation," in which they masturbate with or for each other. People in a couple may also continue to masturbate by themselves.

Masturbation has benefits, including improving an individual's body image, acting as a stress reliever, and providing sexual pleasure for people who choose not to have a sexual relationship with other people.



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◀ 54–55 The penis

Orgasms

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Pornography

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MYTH BUSTER

The truth about masturbation

It isn't something to be ashamed of.

Masturbation is normal, natural, and commonplace. It's not something to feel bad or guilty about doing.

It won't harm you. Masturbation is not emotionally, physically, or mentally harmful.

Masturbation won't affect a person's ability to have children. It has no impact on a person's fertility.

◁ Opportunity to experiment

Masturbation is a way for people to experiment and find out what feels good for them.